

PROJECT SUNRISE

Consolidated Key Facts, Record Findings & Questions

Working civic brief. This document consolidates the most important points from the application materials, environmental forms, conceptual plans, Town/applicant email correspondence, traffic study, survey, deed/title materials, and related records reviewed to date. It separates what the records actually say from questions that remain unresolved.

Site area	Approx. 138.05 acres
Warehouse GFA	Approx. 4,264,725 sq. ft.
With parking garage	Approx. 4,430,709 sq. ft.
Operations	24 hours / 7 days
Truck trips	Approx. 555 average weekday / 809 seasonal peak weekday
Parking	1,500 code-counted employee spaces; EAF lists 2,046 total parking/delivery/trailer spaces
Loading / trailer storage	115 loading bays / 426 trailer spaces
Wastewater	Approx. 61,200 gallons/day
Impervious surface	Approx. 83.80 acres
Forest loss	Approx. 99.87 acres

1. What the Town/applicant emails reveal

These emails are among the most revealing records because they show what was happening behind the formal filing: the Town was not simply processing a routine warehouse application; it was discussing how a project that did not fit ordinary zoning limits might proceed.

- **Town Planning identified major zoning problems very early.** In the July 24 correspondence, Planning staff said the applicant intended to exceed the Industrial 1 maximum height and floor-area ratio and described the required variances as being of "**significant magnitude.**"
- **Planning staff preferred a new Planned Development District (PDD).** The stated reason was to avoid creating a broader precedent in the Industrial 1 district for extraordinary height/FAR departures.
- **The applicant was open to that approach.** Attorney Brian Kennedy wrote that his client was "**not opposed to a new PDD**" and wanted to discuss the Town's preferred zoning path.
- **The FEAF itself had to be corrected.** Planning staff said the environmental form did not accurately characterize the zoning/code actions that would be required and requested a revised FEAF.
- **Amazon was directly participating in the Town discussions.** On August 3, Kennedy advised Town Planning that Danielle Aristy from Amazon would be joining him for the August 4 meeting.
- **After that meeting, the Town called the submission incomplete.** On August 6, Town staff wrote that the application was not complete and asked the applicant to retrieve the incomplete submission while preparing an amended application.
- **The PDD route had not yet been finally selected.** Town staff later clarified that the additional PDD fee would be due only if the client actually decided to apply for PDD rezoning.

2. Zoning, FAR, PDD and the 'public amenities' issue

- **Industrial 1 maximum FAR is 0.35.** The conceptual plan calculates Project Sunrise at roughly 0.71-0.74 depending on whether the parking garage is included - about double the ordinary FAR limit.

- **The plan itself points to a development-bonus model.** A note directs readers to the Town's Downtown Development District development-bonus provisions as example language for increasing maximum FAR for applicants who provide specified public amenities.
- **What that does not prove:** the records do not show that Amazon/Scannell has already offered a specific amenity package or that the Town has agreed to exchange amenities for more FAR.
- **What it does raise:** if extraordinary FAR is ultimately allowed, what public benefit or amenity would be required in return, who would define it, and how would it be enforceable?
- **Recorded Islip Pines covenants and restrictions are another obstacle.** The conceptual plan states that they need to be eliminated or modified to accommodate the proposed action.

Key question for the Town

If Project Sunrise is allowed substantially greater FAR than ordinary Industrial 1 zoning permits, is a development-bonus concept being considered, and if so, what specific public amenities or benefits would be required in exchange?

3. Scale, configuration and future expansion

- The proposed project is approximately **4.264 million square feet** of warehouse/office floor area on roughly 138 acres.
- The southern three-story component is the dominant building, with a footprint of about 1.254 million square feet plus two mezzanine levels and platforms.
- The northern two-story component has a 425,000-sq.-ft. footprint and a **300,000-sq.-ft. mezzanine expressly labeled FUTURE EXPANSION**, bringing that component to about 725,000 square feet.
- The project includes a one-level parking garage, guard houses, drop-off shelter, 115 loading bays, 426 trailer spaces, associate parking and Same-Day/Flex parking.
- Two fire tank/pump-house facilities are shown on the conceptual plan.

4. Traffic study - the strongest findings

- **The study is explicitly for an Amazon logistics facility.** It describes an Amazon Robotics Sortable (ARS) fulfillment component and a Sub Same-Day (SSD) fulfillment component, and it was prepared for Scannell Properties.
- **Peak-hour traffic is substantial:** the study projects about **451 new vehicle trips in the weekday morning peak hour and 998 in the weekday evening peak hour**. The evening peak includes 27 truck trips.
- **The 24-hour traffic schedules came from the e-commerce operator.** The study says its projected site traffic was based on operational schedules supplied for the ARS and SSD facilities, rather than only generic warehouse averages.
- **Average weekday truck traffic is approximately 555 truck trips; seasonal peak weekday truck traffic approximately 809.**
- **The studied road network already has a serious crash history.** Across the 11 intersections in the crash-rate summary table, the calculated crash rate is higher than the NYSDOT comparison average at every listed intersection.
- Examples: Route 454/Lakeland is **1.78 vs. 0.25**; Route 454/Express Drive North **1.66 vs. 0.25**; Broadway/Sunrise South Service Road **1.59 vs. 0.25**; Sunrise North Service Road/Beacon Drive **0.97 vs. 0.12**.
- The collision dataset covers January 1, 2023 through January 1, 2026 and totals **544 reported collisions** across the study intersections.
- **The study acknowledges existing capacity constraints.** It says some movements already operate with significant peak-hour congestion and cannot be improved through minor signal timing changes.
- **Even after mitigation, some movements remain at LOS F.** For example, the seasonal mitigation discussion leaves certain Lakeland Avenue left-turn movements at LOS F.
- **The consultant ultimately concludes there would not be a significant traffic impact**, but that is the consultant's analysis and assumes the proposed roadway improvements, signal changes and traffic-management plan. It should not be

presented as an independent Town finding.

Crash-rate examples from the Traffic Impact Study

Intersection	Crashes	Study crash rate	NYSDOT avg.
NYS 454 & Broadway Ave.	34	0.88	0.25
Broadway & Sunrise South Service Rd.	40	1.59	0.25
Nicolls & Colin/Greenbelt	87	1.12	0.25
Sunrise North Service Rd. & Beacon	46	0.97	0.12
NYS 454 & Lakeland Ave.	106	1.78	0.25
NYS 454 & Express Drive South	77	1.39	0.25
NYS 454 & Express Drive North	80	1.66	0.25

5. Traffic changes the project depends on

- **Route 454/Church Street:** new gateway access, dual left-turn lanes in both directions on Route 454, Church Street widening and a new fully actuated signal.
- **Nicolls Road/Colin Drive/Greenbelt Parkway:** a second northbound left-turn lane, Colin Drive widening and signal-system upgrades.
- **Sunrise North Service Road/Beacon Drive:** Beacon Drive realignment, dual southbound right-turn lanes, extended westbound turn storage, a fourth westbound through lane and a new fully actuated signal.
- The traffic study expressly states that the final scope, design and implementation of these improvements remain subject to Town, Suffolk County and/or NYSDOT review and approval.
- **Truck routing assumption:** site-generated trucks are intended to enter through the new signalized Route 454 gateway. Passenger and Flex traffic is distributed throughout the surrounding network.
- **Beacon Drive still has an overflow-truck function:** the study describes a right-egress-only Beacon Drive driveway for overflow truck traffic, while saying it would not be used on a regular or consistent basis.
- The project also proposes cross-access to the adjacent DYS7/FedEx site along Route 454.

6. Parking - a discrepancy that should be reconciled

- The conceptual plan and traffic study show **1,500 employee parking stalls** (699 garage + 801 surface), plus 120 Same-Day/Flex spaces and 426 trailer spaces.
- The FEAF lists **2,046 proposed parking-related spaces** when employee, Flex and trailer spaces are counted together.
- The Town zoning calculation on the conceptual plan shows **6,859 parking spaces required** under the existing ordinance and only 1,500 code-counted standard/accessible spaces provided.
- These are not necessarily the same counting categories, but the records should clearly explain the parking methodology and why the project's operational demand is considered adequate despite the zoning-code calculation.

7. Environmental and neighborhood impacts

- The project would disturb approximately **101.6 acres**.
- Existing forest is projected to decline from approximately 136.77 acres to about 36.90 acres - a loss of roughly **99.87 acres**.
- Impervious surface after development is listed at about **83.80 acres**.
- The EAF estimates water demand at about **72,000 gallons/day** and sanitary wastewater at about **61,200 gallons/day**.

- The property lies over the Nassau-Suffolk Sole Source Aquifer, with groundwater identified at approximately 19 feet below grade.
- Stormwater is proposed to be handled through drainage reserve areas and subsurface infiltration, with some stormwater reused for irrigation. The EAF states the system is intended to accommodate an eight-inch rainfall event.
- The EAF identifies the former Goldisc Recording site immediately west. Historic contamination included solvents, PVC and plating wastes; remediation is described as complete, while quarterly groundwater monitoring continues.
- The EAF identifies Brightview Sayville senior independent living about 1,200 feet southwest of the project.
- A sound wall is proposed along the northern developed area, along with a substantial vegetated buffer. An operational noise study was still being prepared when the filing was submitted.
- The air-quality/direct-and-indirect greenhouse-gas assessment was also still being prepared.

8. Sewer and utility questions

- Project wastewater is proposed to go to Suffolk County Sewer District No. 14 (Parkland).
- The EAF expressly says there are **no existing sewer lines on the project site** and that consultation with Suffolk County DPW is needed to confirm sewer availability and any line extension.
- The survey and conceptual plan nevertheless show an existing **sanitary sewer easement in favor of Parcel F**. That does not by itself prove there is a usable sewer connection for Project Sunrise.
- The survey also confirms extensive electric, road-crossing, access and utility easements through the property.
- Peak electrical demand is estimated at approximately **12.1 MW**, with PSEG Long Island service and on-site solar anticipated.

9. Property, roads, easements and Town actions

- The proposal contemplates acquiring approximately **0.82 acre** from the Town of Islip.
- It also contemplates dedicating approximately **3.45 acres** to the Town for roadway design/improvements.
- Existing paper streets are proposed to be abandoned. The survey labels Barkley Drive, Kings Road and Church Court as **not open or in use**, with status unknown/possible easement in several locations.
- The survey shows a recharge basin, a 160-foot buffer area, utility easements and the sanitary sewer easement.
- The EAF identifies Town Board actions including the zoning change, rescission of covenants/restrictions, disposition of the Town-owned triangle, acceptance of roadway dedication and abandonment of paper streets.

10. Ownership and Amazon's role

- Islip NY Hold Co., LLC is identified as the property owner/applicant in the Town filing.
- Recorded deed materials reviewed show the assemblage was conveyed by Serota Islip, LLC to Islip NY Hold Co., LLC for a recorded amount of **\$160 million**.
- **The records do not establish that Amazon owns the land.**
- What the records do establish is a direct project-level Amazon role: the traffic study identifies an Amazon logistics facility, operational traffic schedules came from the e-commerce operator, and an Amazon representative was scheduled to attend the August 4 Town meeting with the applicant's attorney.

11. Other approvals and reviews identified in the records

- Town Board zoning and related legislative actions.
- Planning Board/Engineering site-plan approval.
- Town Traffic Safety highway work permit.
- Potential Town of Islip IDA financial assistance.

- Suffolk County Health sanitary/water approvals.
- Suffolk County Sewer Agency / DPW sewer capacity and connection review.
- Suffolk County Planning Commission referral.
- NYSDOT highway work permits.
- NYSDEC construction-stormwater SPDES coverage.
- Suffolk County Water Authority connection.
- PSEG/LIPA access/electric approvals, possible National Grid connection, and FAA no-hazard review.

12. The most important unresolved questions

- **What will the amended application actually change?** The July filing was expressly deemed incomplete.
- **Will the applicant pursue a new PDD?** If yes, what will its standards be and what public benefits/amenities would be required?
- **What exactly do the Islip Pines covenants and restrictions prohibit?** Who has legal authority to rescind or modify them?
- **How will the parking discrepancy be reconciled?** 6,859 code-required versus 1,500 code-counted spaces, while the FEAF lists 2,046 total parking/delivery/trailer spaces.
- **What is the final sewer route and available Parkland capacity?** The project proposes 61,200 gallons/day, yet the site has no existing sewer line.
- **What is the exact function and route of the existing sanitary-sewer easement?**
- **Will all required traffic improvements actually be approved, funded and constructed before occupancy?**
- **How should the Town evaluate traffic safety when every intersection in the study's crash-rate summary table is already above the NYSDOT comparison average?**
- **What do the final noise, air/GHG, lighting, utility and engineering studies show once completed?**
- **How will the Town evaluate cumulative environmental impacts from clearing roughly 100 acres of forest, creating more than 83 acres of impervious surface, adding 24/7 operations and routing substantial traffic through an already constrained network?**

Bottom line: Project Sunrise is not simply a warehouse site-plan review. The records show a project of extraordinary scale that does not fit ordinary Industrial 1 FAR standards, requires substantial roadway and infrastructure work, depends on unresolved zoning and sewer questions, and has prompted direct discussions among Town staff, the applicant and Amazon. The traffic consultant concludes impacts can be managed, but that conclusion rests on operator-supplied traffic schedules and a package of major road improvements that still require governmental approval.

Source note: Figures and statements above are drawn from the Project Sunrise application package, conceptual site plan, Full Environmental Assessment Form and attachments, Town/applicant email correspondence, Stonefield Traffic Impact Study dated June 30, 2026, VHB survey/title materials, and deed/ownership records reviewed in this working file set.